

SOMETHING LIKE PERFECTION
Johnson, a Caravan, is a natural before the camera

In

In canine lineages, one can follow traces of human endeavour, as packs of dogs followed groups of people into new lands. A similar pattern has had some surprising consequences in a parched corner of the Deccan plateau where a distinctive breed of dogs has enlivened a struggling rural economy. A keen look framed by a narrow muzzle, a proud, tall bearing supported by spindly, strong legs, a stomach that curves inward in an 's', and a latent fierceness it's too glad to exhibit—you just cannot miss a Pashmi. In its menacing growl, owners read an ironcast guarantee.

At Janwal village in Maharashtra's Latur district, the stone-walled house of farmer Tanaji Pawar is